

SONEXIAL

The Author Signal Checklist

10 Ways to Make Your Book More Discoverable on Amazon
(In Under an Hour)

Your book is a signal. Is anyone receiving it?

You wrote a great book. But on Amazon, "great" isn't enough. Your book is a silent signal in a deafeningly loud room, competing with millions of others.

This is not a diagnostic. It's an **action plan**.

Open your KDP dashboard on another screen. We're going to fix your signals —right now.

Signal 1: Fix Your Subtitle

Why: Your subtitle is the **#1 keyword location** on your entire product page. A weak subtitle is the most common wasted opportunity.

TAKE ACTION NOW

Use this formula. (Non-Fiction is easier, but for Fiction, focus on genre and theme.)

[Title]: [Hook/Promise] + [Specific Niche/Genre] + [Who It's For]

Example: Leadership Hacks: 20 Quick Fixes + Management Secrets + For New Managers

Example: The Crimson Star: A Space Opera + Military Sci-Fi Thriller + About First Contact

Signal 2: Fix Your First 50 Words

Why: On mobile, Amazon shows only 2-3 lines before the "Read More" link. If those lines don't hook a reader, they will **never** click.

TAKE ACTION NOW

Rewrite your first line using one of these "stop-scroll" templates:

1. The Question: "What if your entire life was a lie? For John Smith, it was..."

2. The Pain Point: "Tired of leadership books that are all theory? This is pure action..."

3. The Promise: "This book will fundamentally change the way you see your career..."

Signal 3: Fix Your Description Readability

Why: No one reads on the web. They **scan**. A giant block of text signals "work" and they'll bounce.

TAKE ACTION NOW

Break your description into scannable chunks:

- **Start with a bold hook** (1-2 sentences that grab attention)
- **Use short paragraphs** (2-3 sentences max)
- **Add bullet points** for key benefits or chapters
- **End with a call to action** ("Scroll up and click Buy Now")

Tip: In Author Central, you can use basic HTML formatting to add bold text and bullets.

Signal 4: Fix Your 7 KDP Keywords

Why: Most authors use single, broad words (e.g., "thriller"). This is like shouting into a hurricane. You need to use the *exact phrases readers type*.

TAKE ACTION NOW

Go to Amazon. Type your broad genre (e.g., "leadership") into the search bar.

Do not hit Enter.

Write down the auto-complete suggestions. *These are what people are searching for.*

Weak: leadership

Strong: leadership books for new managers

Find 7 of these long-tail phrases and add them to your KDP keyword slots.

Signal 5: Fix Your Categories

Why: You won't be the #1 Bestseller in "Business & Money." You *can* be the #1 Bestseller in "Business & Money > Management > Office Culture."

TAKE ACTION NOW

Find the #1 book in your broad *dream* category. Scroll down to "Product details."

Copy their *smallest, most niche* category string (e.g., Books > Business & Money > Sales > Sales Management).

Log in to KDP, go to "Help," and email KDP Support to add your book to that exact niche category.

Signal 6: Fix Your Author Bio

Why: The bio's job is to answer: "Why should I trust *this* author on *this* topic?"

TAKE ACTION NOW

Use one of these formulas. (NF = Non-Fiction, F = Fiction)

NF Formula: [Name] is a [Your Title/Expertise] who helps [Your Audience] [Solve Their Problem]. As a [Credential/Proof Point], [he/she/they] [Accomplishment].

F Formula: [Name] writes [Genre] for fans of [Comp Author 1] and [Comp Author 2]. [He/She/They] [Personal/Fun Detail that builds genre authority].

Signal 7: Fix Your Author Central Page

Why: An empty Author Central page (no bio, no photo) signals "hobbyist." A complete profile builds instant authority.

TAKE ACTION NOW

Go to `author.amazon.com` and do these three things:

1. Upload your professional headshot.
2. Copy and paste your new bio (from Signal 6 above).
3. Link your blog/website feed (if you have one).

Signal 8: Fix Your A+ Content

Why: This is free, premium "billboard" space Amazon gives you. Not using it is a massive missed opportunity.

TAKE ACTION NOW

In your KDP "Marketing" tab, click "A+ Content."

Don't see it? You need to be enrolled in KDP Select or have completed a few sales first. Skip this signal for now and come back to it later.

Choose the "Standard Image & Dark Text Overlay" module. Upload a high-quality, atmospheric image (you can get one from Unsplash) and paste your single *best* review quote over it.

You've now 10x'd your visual appeal in 5 minutes.

Signal 9: Fix Your Editorial Reviews

Why: This section is **curated by you**. It's your place to put your best "blurbs." An empty one is a red flag.

TAKE ACTION NOW

Go to your Goodreads page or social media. Find *one* good 5-star review from a blogger or fellow author.

Go to Author Central > "Books" > [Your Book] > "Edit Editorial Reviews." Copy and paste that review in. It adds immense social proof.

Signal 10: Fix Your "Look Inside"

Why: The "Look Inside" is your digital bookstore browse. If your first page is blank, copyright info, or a long dedication, you've lost the sale.

TAKE ACTION NOW

Click "Look Inside" on your book. Is the *very first thing* the reader sees your hook? Is it Chapter 1? Or is it "Copyright 2025..."?

If it's not the hook, go to your manuscript file, move "Chapter 1" to be the *absolute first page* (before the title page), and re-upload your file to KDP.

Did You Fix Your Signals?

You just did an hour of optimization work that puts you ahead of 90% of other authors. But this is just the foundation.

Our **Metadata & Amazon Optimization Kit** gives you the complete system: 5 professionally crafted descriptions, advanced keyword clusters for your genre, category research, bio templates, and more.

Launching February 1, 2025 • First 50 buyers save \$20

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